

HOUSING ALLIANCE OF PENNSYLVANIA

Nicole Semenza, LSW

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Philadelphia Region

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TO

Hiring Committee
Housing Alliance of Pennsylvania
1501 Cherry Street
Philadelphia, PA 19102

DATE

March 16, 2026

ROLE

Policy Director

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am excited to apply for the Policy Director position with the Housing Alliance of Pennsylvania. Safe, decent, and affordable housing is foundational to health, family stability, and opportunity, which is why your mission resonates so strongly with me. I am especially drawn to the Housing Alliance's coalition model and commitment to elevating provider and lived-experience perspectives in state and federal advocacy.

Over the past eight years, I have built a career around policy, advocacy, and stakeholder engagement. At Venture Global Consulting, I helped develop legislative agendas, track legislation, engage lawmakers and staff, and organize Advocacy Days in Washington, DC. At CADCA, I built bipartisan support across congressional chambers and developed advocacy toolkits and legislative alerts used by more than 5,000 coalition members. Earlier, in the office of Congresswoman Roybal-Allard, I managed a health policy portfolio for an appropriator and coordinated partner engagement to inform legislative priorities.

I would also bring strong policy analysis and policy education experience to this role. At the Prenatal-to-Three Policy Impact Center at the LBJ School of Public Affairs, I conducted evidence reviews and policy research on issues including Medicaid expansion, group prenatal care, doula services, and screening programs for children. I translated those findings into technical briefs and annual reports for agencies and policymakers and responded to requests from legislative staff and partner organizations.

While my background has centered on health and prevention policy rather than housing policy specifically, the throughline has been consistent: helping organizations develop policy priorities, engage partners, and advocate for better outcomes for families and communities. Based in South Jersey, I am available for regular in-person work in Philadelphia and frequent travel to Harrisburg. After several years focused on full-time caregiving, I am eager to return to full-time policy leadership in a role where strong advocacy, coalition-building, and clear communication can support lasting systems change.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my legislative, coalition, and policy research experience could support the Housing Alliance's agenda and help strengthen advocacy for safe and affordable housing across Pennsylvania.

Sincerely,

Nicole Semenza, LSW

POLICY DIRECTOR APPLICATION

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Policy, research, and advocacy professional with 8+ years of experience advancing legislative priorities, building coalitions, translating research into policy action, and developing public-facing advocacy materials across health and social-impact issues. Track record of engaging legislators, staff, agencies, and partner organizations to move complex priorities through policy development, stakeholder outreach, and evidence-based communications. Strong writer and analyst experienced in policy analysis, technical briefs, legislative reports, action alerts, and partner-facing education. Philadelphia-region candidate based in South Jersey, available for regular in-person work in Philadelphia and frequent travel to Harrisburg.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Policy and legislative strategy
- Legislative tracking and policy analysis
- Policymaker meetings and stakeholder outreach
- Technical briefs and evidence reviews
- Policy briefings, reports, and presentations
- Research evaluation and content analysis
- State and federal advocacy
- Coalition-building and partner engagement
- Public policy communications
- Action alerts and advocacy toolkits
- Cross-sector relationship management
- Policy reports and publications

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Policy Research Associate, Prenatal-to-Three Policy Impact Center The LBJ School of Public Affairs, University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX | October 2020-March 2022

- Conducted policy research and technical evidence reviews on Medicaid expansion, group prenatal care, doula services, and child screening programs, translating complex findings for agencies and policymakers considering funding and program improvements.
- Served as the women's and children's health policy subject-matter contributor, supporting evidence-based policy development and cross-team dissemination.
- Responded to requests from legislative staff and partner organizations regarding policy positions and research to improve outcomes for families.

Director, Legislative Affairs and Advocacy Venture Global Consulting

Alexandria, VA / Austin, TX | August 2018-September 2020

- Advanced client policy priorities by helping develop legislative agendas, track legislation, and engage legislators, staff, and external stakeholders.
- Oversaw and organized Advocacy Days in Washington, DC to strengthen support for advocacy goals across partners with varied perspectives.
- Developed public-facing advocacy materials, including op-eds, letters of support, and reports, to support legislative strategy and policy education.

Public Policy Manager; Public Policy Associate Community Anti-Drug Coalitions of America (CADCA)

Alexandria, VA | June 2017-August 2018

- Managed stakeholder engagement across congressional chambers to build bipartisan support for national substance abuse prevention initiatives.
- Developed advocacy toolkits and legislative alerts used by 5,000+ coalition members, helping local coalitions engage lawmakers across congressional districts.
- Prepared reports, presentations, and publications highlighting grant program results for policymakers, partners, and member audiences.
- Executed strategic community engagement initiatives to deepen external partnerships and advance coalition priorities.

Professional Experience Continued

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Legislative Fellow

Washington, DC | January 2017-June 2017

The Office of Congresswoman Roybal-Allard (CA-40)

- Managed the health policy portfolio for an appropriator, Congresswoman Roybal-Allard.
- Served as congressional lead for the Women's Working Group on Immigration, partnering with public and private stakeholders to advance policy initiatives.
- Worked in a fast-moving legislative environment that required clear communication and coordination across internal and external stakeholders.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Time Parent

Cinnaminson, NJ | March 2022-Present

Career chapter focused on full-time caregiving and family leadership responsibilities.

Research Associate

Hartford, CT | December 2015-April 2017

UConn Rudd Center for Food Policy and Obesity

- Conducted content analysis for the FACTS 2017 report on food advertising targeting parents.
- Managed participant recruitment and engagement for public health research studies.

Volunteer in Service to America (VISTA)

West Haven, CT | August 2012-August 2013

AmeriCorps, University of New Haven

- Managed the Community Work-Study program, increasing student participation by 40% through targeted outreach and collaboration.
- Conducted site visits and built relationships with local nonprofit partners to strengthen university-community engagement.

EDUCATION

University of Connecticut School of Social Work

Master of Social Work (MSW), Policy Practice Concentration

Women, Children, and Families Specialization | Urban Service Track / Area Health Education Center Scholar

University of Connecticut

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Psychology | Minor in Criminal Justice